

Newsletter No 13

**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

NOVEMBER 2024



CELEBRATING ACADEMIC SUCCESS

Despite all these challenges, the school has made remarkable academic strides. Our focus on literacy, numeracy and critical thinking skills has shown real results with our learners consistently out performing in their assessments. For example, one of our learners in Grade Three displayed a remarkable achievement with a 100% score in the Kenya national assessment!

75 Kindergarten learners have graduated to Primary and our Grade Six will join Junior Secondary school come next year.

We're also proud of our learners' achievements beyond the classroom: our girls participated in a football tournament and they emerged the winners within the region! This achievement reminds us that our work at Rossholme is not only academic, it's about nurturing well rounded individuals ready to make a difference in their community.

The impact of Starlink

CONNECTING US TO THE WORLD

This year, we witnessed a transformative change with the internet installation at Rossholme School. In a community where reliable internet is a luxury, the arrival of the internet is a game changer at Rossholme School. This has really empowered our learners and teachers with the resources they could only dream of before. For example, online learning tools and access to up-to-date educational materials: we were only able to do this through the support of our friends!

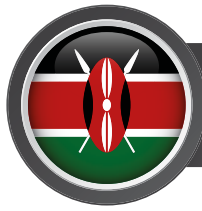
HEADMISTRESS UPDATE

Dear Trustees, friends and the Rossholme family.

We trust this mail finds you well. We're fine too. We've come to the end of the 2024 academic year and we're so grateful to our God. We wish to reflect on the happiness, achievements and challenges that we encountered in our 2024 academic year. We are very grateful for being part of this journey!



For our learners, Starlink allows the development of essential digital skills for their future careers and the ability to learn virtual collaboration. The joy in their faces tells it all as they learn.



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IMPACT OF FLOODING ON KIRSTY'S PLACE

The recent devastating floods in Kenya have wreaked havoc on communities across the country, including the Mathare and Kiambiu slums in Nairobi. Among the hardest hit by the heavy rains is Kirsty's Daycare, a key facility run by the non-profit organization Tushinde and supported by Rossholme School in Kenya, which serves vulnerable families in the region. The flooding has left the daycare's premises severely damaged, disrupting critical services for children and their families.

Tushinde have shared a report with us which details the impact of the flooding to Kirsty's Place and surrounding area. The report states that "the floods have caused significant damage to our facilities. Flood waters infiltrated the building, destroying furniture, walls, and essential learning materials," writes Wanjiru Kariuki. "Our priority right now is to ensure the safety of the children and staff while we begin the long process of cleaning, repairing, and restoring essential services."

The flooding, which has affected much of Nairobi and other parts of Kenya, has worsened health and sanitation challenges, particularly in the slum areas. "With sanitation facilities compromised, there's a heightened risk of water-borne diseases like cholera and typhoid. We're working hard to implement enhanced hygiene protocols to prevent an outbreak," the Program Coordinator added.

In addition to the physical damage, many children have shown signs of emotional distress due to the disruption of their daily routines. "The emotional impact on children has been significant. We're using creative activities and psycho-social support to help them process the trauma and stress caused by this disaster," said the coordinator.

PARTNERSHIPS TO THE RESCUE

Tushinde is receiving critical support from Rossholme which has been involved with Tushinde for several years. It has pledged to help with both immediate relief and long-term rebuilding efforts. As part of their recovery plan, Tushinde is focusing on addressing the broader infrastructure issues that contribute to flooding in the area. "We need to explore ways to improve the flood resilience of our daycare centres. This includes upgrading drainage systems, reinforcing buildings, and even considering

relocation options to avoid future disasters," the coordinator explained.

So many homes and properties were carried away in Kiambiu slum especially the ones near the river. A good number of our learners were affected. Their homes and all properties were carried away and so they had to relocate. It was not easy at all. In the coming months we will be launching a specific fundraising drive for Kirsty's Place and we look forward to sharing those ideas with you.

FLOOD CHALLENGE.

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GOING FORWARD 2025

As we start our new year in 2025, our goal is to improve our infrastructure, expanding our educational programs and fostering more partnerships to enhance learning experience for our students. Thank you for supporting Rossholme. and believing in our mission. Thank you for supporting us in every way; we're deeply grateful to you all



THE ROUGH RAMBLE FOR ROSSHOLME

It was a misty, moist morning on Dartmoor in the South West of England, when Kitty Hollingsworth and her nephew Christian Edbrooke (pictured right) set off at 6am to walk 26 miles across the moors. At this stage, they were accompanied by Kitty's brother, Tim and his other son, Robin. As the day progressed, a further 14 intrepid walkers disappeared into the mist to trek distances across the moor from 2 -15 miles.

Every walker was sponsored or had contributed to the Rossholme School in Kenya fund and the collecting tin was well rattled in the tea shop where we gathered in the morning and later in the pub in the village of Holne where we were all warmly welcomed.

It was in 2022 when Kitty first demonstrated her support for Rossholme by walking a marathon; last year, she was joined for the first time by her nephew, Christian, so this year, her third marathon trek across Dartmoor, numerous others were invited to join in. Rossholme is very grateful to her for raising significant amounts and, as she and Christian completed over 27 miles this year, we called Joyce Aruga in Nairobi who was delighted to be able to thank them personally.

Most people in this rural community, comprising seven villages and hamlets on the Somerset/Devon border are aware of Rossholme and contribute in various different ways, including our collecting tins in the Stawley Village Shop and Tea Room and The Globe pub in Appley. This happy get together on Dartmoor proved to be such a fun day for the participants and supporters – and several dogs as well – we hope it will become an annual fund-raising event. The total raised from this year's Rough Ramble so far is over £1700 and further donations are still coming in...thank you so much, Kitty, for initiating it and thank you to our generous supporters and donors!





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STARLINK INSTALLATION

(Cont. from
front cover)

Registered as a Charitable
Incorporated Organisation
(CIO), Charity No 1178553
Registered as a
Charitable Incorporated
Organisation (CIO), Charity
No 1178553

For further info please
contact Judy Webb
judy@rossholmeinkeny.org

FUNDRAISING

We are a registered charity
(number 1178553) which
means that Gift Aid can be
claimed on donations made
by UK tax payers. Donations
can now be made through
CAF Donate which can
be accessed through our
website:

www.rossholmeinkeny.org

CAF Donate will also
process the GiftAid or,
alternatively, if donations
are made directly to the
charity, a GiftAid form can
be downloaded from the
website and returned to:
judy@rossholmeinkeny.org
25% Gift Aid makes a
significant difference to
the donations you are
kind enough to make.
Unfortunately,

We aim to publish a
Newsletter about every
6 months so, if you know
of anyone else who may
be interested in receiving
one by email, please let us
know. In line with GDPR, we
need permission for names
to be on a mailing list but
we assure you that it is not
published anywhere; it is
retained only by us and all
emails are BCC'd so no list of
emails is available.

CAF
Charities Aid Foundation

Fleximedia • 07749032181
is proud to support &
donate their time to design
the Rossholme in Kenya
Newsletter

In September, thanks to your generous
donations, we were able to fund the installation
of an internet link for the school utilising the
satellite internet constellation operated by
Starlink.

Introducing internet access to schools in
Kenya brings obvious advantages, enhancing
education and opportunities for students and
teachers alike. One key benefit is the vast access
to learning resources. The internet connects
students to global content, including online
courses, educational videos, and e-libraries,
expanding their knowledge beyond textbooks.

For teachers, the internet offers multimedia resources and interactive lessons, making
complex subjects easier to grasp - all things we take for granted in the UK.



EASY FUNDRAISING

We are grateful for all of your
fundraising efforts and the support
you provide the children of Rossholme
School in Kenya.

In recent months we have been exploring new
ways to raise funds to support our pupils and
to continue to provide for them. The school
is growing rapidly and naturally, so are the
costs. Through easy fundraising we are now
able to raise funds of purchases which are
made online. Organisations and retailers
support this by provide a percentage of
your purchase as a contribution to a charity.
Rossholme School in Kenya is now all signed
up and we would be grateful for your support.
It costs you nothing; the donation comes from
the organisations and retailers which support
the scheme and from whom you make a
purchase.



The QR code can
be scanned and
following the simple
instruction you will
be able to fundraise
just by doing your
Christmas shopping.